SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

26 July 2022 · Shift 2

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 22 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. I tried to tell him to think of the good times, that “every cloud has a silver lining.”

(A) Doing something with thoroughness and passion
(B) Don’t cry over what has happened as it cannot be fixed
(C) Treat people the same way as you want to be treated
(D) Every difficult situation has a hopeful aspect to it

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Expository

(A) Illustrative
(B) Temperamental
(C) Obligatory
(D) Dubious

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The first printed _____ of this book came in 1933.

(A) excretion
(B) insertion
(C) addition
(D) edition

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Pull someone’s legs

(A) To tease someone
(B) To protect someone
(C) To wish someone luck
(D) To make someone angry

Q.5

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who produces beautiful handwriting

(A) stenographer
(B) Philosopher
(C) Calligrapher
(D) Typographer

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. He certainly failed to “console” the new king.

(A) Agitate
(B) Coordinate
(C) Satiate
(D) Gratify

Q.7

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Simultanous
(B) Simultenaous
(C) Simultaneous
(D) Simulteneous

Q.8

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. His successful as a lawyer / grew so fast that he soon had / enough money to buy a house.

(A) No error
(B) grew so fast that he soon had
(C) enough money to buy a house
(D) His successful as a lawyer

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A state of perfect balance

(A) Equilibrium
(B) Extempore
(C) Medieval
(D) Irrelevant

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Admirable

(A) Blameworthy
(B) Practical
(C) Reasonable
(D) Tolerant

Q.12

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The enemies "have cross" the border, treading the soil on which they are to be conquered.

(A) No improvement required
(B) have crossed
(C) has crossed
(D) have crossing

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Consumers are not ready to purchase this citrus fruit at such a _____ price.

(A) higher
(B) highest
(C) highly
(D) high

Q.15

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Other South African cities only / had one venue for staging exhibitions or / internationals events at highly standard.

(A) No error
(B) internationals events at highly standard
(C) Other South African cities only
(D) had one venue for staging exhibitions or

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Sparkling

(A) Dismal
(B) Muffled
(C) Gleaming
(D) Unexciting

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Please don't _____ anyone that I came to your birthday party.

(A) told
(B) said
(C) tell
(D) say

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Seclude

(A) Blink
(B) socialize
(C) Confine
(D) Isolate

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A sustained decline in Chinese consumption would be even more _____ than the current US-China trade dispute.

(A) worrying
(B) imagining
(C) delaying
(D) mobilising

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a significant find, the Epigraphy Branch of the Archaeological Survey of India (1) _____ discovered the earliest epigraphic evidence so far for the Saptamatrika cult. It is also (2) _____ earliest Sanskrit inscription to have been discovered (3) _____ South India as of date. Saptamatrikas are a group of seven female deities worshipped in Hinduism as personifying the energy of their respective consorts. The inscription is in Sanskrit and in Brahmi characters and was (4) _____ by Satavahana King Vijaya in 207 A.D. The inscription came to light when some local villagers informed the authorities of the presence of a pillar with some engravings when they were restoring and (5) _____ the local Bheemeshwara temple.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) have
(B) has
(C) is
(D) are

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a significant find, the Epigraphy Branch of the Archaeological Survey of India (1) _____ discovered the earliest epigraphic evidence so far for the Saptamatrika cult. It is also (2) _____ earliest Sanskrit inscription to have been discovered (3) _____ South India as of date. Saptamatrikas are a group of seven female deities worshipped in Hinduism as personifying the energy of their respective consorts. The inscription is in Sanskrit and in Brahmi characters and was (4) _____ by Satavahana King Vijaya in 207 A.D. The inscription came to light when some local villagers informed the authorities of the presence of a pillar with some engravings when they were restoring and (5) _____ the local Bheemeshwara temple.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) an
(B) the
(C) a
(D) one

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a significant find, the Epigraphy Branch of the Archaeological Survey of India (1) _____ discovered the earliest epigraphic evidence so far for the Saptamatrika cult. It is also (2) _____ earliest Sanskrit inscription to have been discovered (3) _____ South India as of date. Saptamatrikas are a group of seven female deities worshipped in Hinduism as personifying the energy of their respective consorts. The inscription is in Sanskrit and in Brahmi characters and was (4) _____ by Satavahana King Vijaya in 207 A.D. The inscription came to light when some local villagers informed the authorities of the presence of a pillar with some engravings when they were restoring and (5) _____ the local Bheemeshwara temple.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) upon
(B) on
(C) In
(D) at

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a significant find, the Epigraphy Branch of the Archaeological Survey of India (1) _____ discovered the earliest epigraphic evidence so far for the Saptamatrika cult. It is also (2) _____ earliest Sanskrit inscription to have been discovered (3) _____ South India as of date. Saptamatrikas are a group of seven female deities worshipped in Hinduism as personifying the energy of their respective consorts. The inscription is in Sanskrit and in Brahmi characters and was (4) _____ by Satavahana King Vijaya in 207 A.D. The inscription came to light when some local villagers informed the authorities of the presence of a pillar with some engravings when they were restoring and (5) _____ the local Bheemeshwara temple.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) refused
(B) chased
(C) issued
(D) denied

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a significant find, the Epigraphy Branch of the Archaeological Survey of India (1) _____ discovered the earliest epigraphic evidence so far for the Saptamatrika cult. It is also (2) _____ earliest Sanskrit inscription to have been discovered (3) _____ South India as of date. Saptamatrikas are a group of seven female deities worshipped in Hinduism as personifying the energy of their respective consorts. The inscription is in Sanskrit and in Brahmi characters and was (4) _____ by Satavahana King Vijaya in 207 A.D. The inscription came to light when some local villagers informed the authorities of the presence of a pillar with some engravings when they were restoring and (5) _____ the local Bheemeshwara temple.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) repairing
(B) removing
(C) healing
(D) praying

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 864, 432, 216, 108,?

(A) 72
(B) 36
(C) 54
(D) 12

Q.2

In a certain code language, 'PAR' is coded as ‘35' and 'GAT' is coded as ‘28'. How will 'FOM' be coded in that language?

(A) 33
(B) 34
(C) 35
(D) 32

Q.3

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 25 : 125 :: 32 : 160 :: 73 : ?

(A) 383
(B) 195
(C) 365
(D) 173

Q.4

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (36, 2, 3)(108, 6, 3)

(A) (120, 5, 5)
(B) (48, 4, 2)
(C) (102, 3, 6)
(D) (28, 4, 2)

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. CET : ZBQ :: KVO : HSL :: QRS : ?

(A) NPS
(B) NOP
(C) NPO
(D) NOS

Q.7

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statement I: An IT employee working in XYZ company has two children. Statement II: No other employee in XYZ has two children. Conclusion I: Every employee in the company has at least one child. Conclusion II: Some of the employees have more than two children.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Only conclusion I follows.
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follow.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.9

What will be the value of the following expression, if '+' and '×' are interchanged and '–' and '÷' are interchanged? 8 × 10 + 3 – 5 ÷ 6 = ?

(A) 4
(B) 6
(C) 12
(D) 8

Q.11

Select the option in which the pair of letter-clusters share the same relationship as that shared by the given letter-clusters. RS : IH

(A) TM : GN
(B) BX : CY
(C) RS : IT
(D) AJ : ZK

Q.12

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 72, 66, 63, 57, 54, 48, ?

(A) 58
(B) 39
(C) 45
(D) 43

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'SEAT' is written as '2' and 'CHARGE' is written as '4'. How will 'ONLINE' be written in that language?

(A) 3
(B) 6
(C) 2
(D) 5

Q.14

Six friends, Kushal, Keshav, Kishan, Kamal, Kanan and Kishore, are of different heights. Keshav is taller than only three other friends. Kishore is taller than Kamal only. Kishan is shorter than Kushal only.Who is the third shortest among all the friends?

(A) Kushal
(B) Keshav
(C) Kishore
(D) Kanan

Q.16

Five men O1, O2, O3, O4 and O5 are sitting around a circular table facing opposite to the centre (not necessarily in the same order). Only one man is sitting between O4 and O5 in clockwise direction. Only one man is sitting between O3 and O4 in clockwise direction. O1 is sitting to the immediate left of O3. Who is sitting third from the left of O2?

(A) O5
(B) O3
(C) O1
(D) O4

Q.17

In a certain code language, '254' means 'You are intelligent', '153' means 'Nikhil is intelligent', '398' means 'Naina and Nikhil', then what is the code for 'is' in the same code language?

(A) 1
(B) 3
(C) 5
(D) 8

Q.18

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some peas are pineapples. No pineapple is a broccoli. All broccolis are potatoes. Conclusions: I. Some peas being potatoes is a possibility. II. All pineapples being potatoes is a possibility.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.20

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. GA, MU, SO, ?, EC

(A) ZI
(B) ZJ
(C) YI
(D) YJ

Q.21

In a certain code language, ‘pinch of salt grey’ is written as ‘ab tr # kp’, ‘grey colour is black’ is written as ‘# jm bk if’ and ‘colour are of track’ is written as ‘gt if ab fr’. How will ‘grey of’ be written in that language?

(A) ab #
(B) gt #
(C) ab if
(D) gt fr

Q.22

By interchanging the two signs ÷ and + and two numbers 9 and 12 (NOT digits), which of the following equations will NOT be correct? I. $12 \times 2 - 72 + 9 \div 57 = 69$; II. $169 + 13 \times 12 \div 3 - 9 = 108$

(A) Neither I nor II
(B) Both I and II
(C) Only II
(D) Only I

Q.24

Ajay, Priti, Rakesh, Mehak, Saloni and Yogesh are sitting in a row facing north. Saloni and Yogesh are sitting in the centre. Ajay and Priti are at the ends. Rakesh is sitting to the immediate left of Ajay.Who is sitting to the immediate right of Priti?

(A) Yogesh
(B) Saloni
(C) Mehak
(D) Rakesh

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. Vehicle : Car :: Food : Pizza :: Crockery : ?

(A) Language
(B) Plate
(C) Table
(D) Stove

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

_____, popularly known as Punjab Kesari took his last breath on November 17th, 1928

(A) Dadabhai Naoroji
(B) Swami Vivekananda
(C) Lala Lajpat Rai
(D) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

Q.2

Which of the following Constitutional Amendment incorporated Dadra, Nagar and Haveli in the Union of India as a Union Territory?

(A) 19th
(B) 14th
(C) 12th
(D) 10th

Q.3

Guru Bipin Singh received 'Sangeet Natak Akademi Award' in the year 1966. He was a teacher of _____ dance.

(A) Manipuri
(B) Kathak
(C) Odissi
(D) Bharatanatyam

Q.4

Smart cities and Academia Towards Action and Research (SAAR) scheme was launched by the _____.

(A) Ministry of Commerce and Industry
(B) Ministry of Culture
(C) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
(D) Ministry of External Affairs

Q.5

In which state of India is the Moatsu festival celebrated every year?

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Karnataka
(C) Nagaland
(D) Jharkhand

Q.6

Which of the following pair of 'Name of Ruler – Empire' is correctly matched? I. Mahapadma Nanda – Magadha Empire; II. Ajatasattu – Maurya Empire

(A) Only II
(B) Neither I nor II
(C) Both I and II
(D) Only I

Q.7

How many types of igneous rocks are there?

(A) Four
(B) Two
(C) Six
(D) Five

Q.8
Which of the following terms is NOT associated with hockey?

(A) Scoop
(B) Flick
(C) Hit
(D) Run out

Q.9
In which state of India is the Gulbarga Fort situated?

(A) Karnataka
(B) Himachal Pradesh
(C) Assam
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.10
Which of the following formulas is correct for Gross Value Added?

(A) Gross Value Added = Gross National Product – Subsidies + Taxes
(B) Gross Value Added = Gross Domestic Product – Subsidies + Taxes
(C) Gross Value Added = Gross National Product + Subsidies – Taxes
(D) Gross Value Added = Gross Domestic Product + Subsidies – Taxes

Q.11
_____ is used to get rid of indigestion.

(A) Antibiotic
(B) Analgesic
(C) Antiseptic
(D) Antacid

Q.12
Which of the following countries had a higher average population density than India in 2020 as per Food and Agriculture Organization and World Bank population estimates?

(A) Russia
(B) Sri Lanka
(C) Bangladesh
(D) China

Q.13
'Waiting for a Visa' is a 20-page autobiography written by _____.

(A) Ram Mohan Roy
(B) Jawaharlal Nehru
(C) Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar
(D) Mahatma Gandhi

Q.14
AR Rahman won the Grammy Awards for which movie?

(A) Slumdog Millionaire
(B) Roja
(C) Lagaan
(D) Dil Se

Q.15
Shovana Narayan is associated with which classical dance of India?

(A) Sattriya
(B) Mohiniyattam
(C) Kathak
(D) Bharatnatyam

Q.16
Which Constitutional Amendment Act included Fundamental Duties in the Indian Constitution?

(A) Twenty-second Amendment Act
(B) Forty-second Amendment Act
(C) Fifty-second Amendment Act
(D) Thirty-second Amendment Act

Q.17
Queen Rudramadevi belonged to which dynasty of India?

(A) Chola
(B) Kakatiya
(C) Chalukya
(D) Chera

Q.18
The SI unit of work is _____.

(A) Decibel
(B) Joule
(C) Pascal
(D) Hertz

Q.19
Which of the following is a rabi crop?

(A) Groundnut
(B) Maize
(C) Paddy
(D) Gram

Q.20
Which of the following persons was conferred with the 57th Jnanpith Award?

(A) Krishna Sobti
(B) Damodar Mauzo
(C) Kedarnath Singh
(D) Amitav Ghosh

Q.21
The distribution of the population according to different types of occupation is known as _____.

(A) occupational structure
(B) age composition
(C) adolescent population
(D) migration

Q.22
_____ is commonly known as imperfect fungi because only the asexual or vegetative phases of these fungi are known.

(A) Phycomycetes
(B) Basidiomycetes
(C) Deuteromycetes
(D) Ascomycetes

Q.23
_____ is broadly divided into Western Ghats and Eastern Ghats.

(A) Himalayan mountains
(B) Northern plains
(C) Deccan plateau
(D) Central highlands

Q.24
When Alivardi Khan died in 1756, _____ became the nawab of Bengal.

(A) Mir Jafar
(B) Siraj-ud-daulah
(C) Murshed Quli Khan
(D) Mir Qasim

Q.25
Which Indian Olympian is associated with golf?

(A) Abhinav Bindra
(B) Neeraj Chopra
(C) Ravi Kumar Dahiya
(D) Aditi Ashok

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**
Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**		

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) Every difficult situation has a hopeful aspect to it

'Every cloud has a silver lining' means that even a bad or difficult situation has something hopeful or good in it.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Illustrative

'Expository' means meant to explain or describe, as is 'illustrative'. 'Temperamental' means moody, 'obligatory' compulsory and 'dubious' doubtful.

Q.3 · Answer (D) edition

An 'edition' is one printed version of a book, so the first printed edition is its first publication.

Q.4 · Answer (A) To tease someone

To pull someone's leg (as the idiom usually goes) is to tease them playfully, often by making them believe something untrue.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Calligrapher

A calligrapher practises calligraphy, the art of beautiful handwriting. A stenographer writes in shorthand, and a typographer designs and arranges printed type.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Agitate

To 'console' is to comfort someone in distress, so its opposite is 'agitate', to upset or disturb. 'Gratify' and 'satiate' mean to please or satisfy.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Simultaneous

The correct spelling is 'simultaneous', ending in '-taneous'; the other three drop, swap or change a vowel in that ending.

Q.8 · Answer (D) His successful as a lawyer

The subject of 'grew' must be a noun, not the adjective 'successful': 'His success as a lawyer grew so fast that he soon had enough money to buy a house.'

Q.9 · Answer (A) Equilibrium

'Equilibrium' is a state of balance between opposing forces. 'Extempore' means without preparation and 'medieval' belonging to the Middle Ages.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Blameworthy

'Admirable' means deserving praise, so its opposite is 'blameworthy', deserving blame.

Q.12 · Answer (B) have crossed

The present perfect is 'have' with the past participle, and the plural 'enemies' takes 'have': 'The enemies have crossed the border.'

Q.14 · Answer (D) high

'Such a' takes the plain adjective before a noun: 'at such a high price'. 'Higher' would need 'than', 'highest' needs 'the', and 'highly' is an adverb.

Q.15 · Answer (B) internationals events at highly standard

An adjective before a noun takes no plural ending, and 'standard' needs the adjective 'high', not the adverb 'highly': 'international events of a high standard'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Gleaming

'Sparkling' means shining brightly, as 'gleaming' does. 'Dismal', 'muffled' and 'unexciting' suggest dullness.

Q.18 · Answer (C) tell

After 'don't' comes the base form of the verb, and 'tell' takes the person told as its object: 'don't tell anyone'. 'Say' needs 'to' before the person ('say to anyone').

Q.19 · Answer (B) socialize
To 'seclude' is to keep oneself or someone away from other people, so its opposite is to 'socialize', to mix with others. 'Confine' and 'isolate' are close to it in meaning.

Q.20 · Answer (A) worrying
A lasting fall in Chinese spending would be a cause for concern, even more 'worrying' than the trade dispute; the other words do not fit the sense.

Q.21 · Answer (B) has
'The Epigraphy Branch' is singular, so the present perfect takes 'has': 'has discovered'.

Q.22 · Answer (B) the
A superlative such as 'earliest' takes 'the': 'the earliest Sanskrit inscription'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) In
'In' goes with a region: discovered 'in South India'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) issued
A king 'issues' an inscription or edict, that is, has it made and put up: 'was issued by Satavahana King Vijaya'.

Q.25 · Answer (A) repairing
'Repairing' goes with 'restoring' as work done on an old building: 'restoring and repairing the local Bheemeshwara temple'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) 54
Each term is half the one before: 108 ÷ 2 = 54.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 34
The code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet: P + A + R = 16 + 1 + 18 = 35 and G + A + T = 7 + 1 + 20 = 28. So F + O + M = 6 + 15 + 13 = 34.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 365
Each second number is 5 times the first: 25 × 5 = 125 and 32 × 5 = 160. So 73 × 5 = 365.

Q.4 · Answer (B) (48, 4, 2)
In each set the first number is 6 times the product of the other two: 2 × 3 × 6 = 36 and 6 × 3 × 6 = 108. Likewise 4 × 2 × 6 = 48; the other sets give 150, 108 and 48 instead of 120, 102 and 28.

Q.5 · Answer (B) NOP
Each letter moves 3 places back: C, E, T → Z, B, Q and K, V, O → H, S, L. So Q, R, S → N, O, P: NOP.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Neither conclusion I nor II follow.
The statements say only who in the company has two children: nothing about whether every employee has a child, or whether anyone has more than two. So neither conclusion follows.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 8
After interchanging the signs: 8 + 10 × 3 ÷ 5 − 6 = 8 + 6 − 6 = 8.

Q.11 · Answer (A) TM : GN
Each letter is paired with its opposite in the alphabet (A↔Z, B↔Y and so on): R↔I and S↔H. Likewise T↔G and M↔N.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 45
The terms fall by 6 and 3 in turn: 72 − 6 = 66, 66 − 3 = 63, 63 − 6 = 57, 57 − 3 = 54, 54 − 6 = 48 and 48 − 3 = 45.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 3
The code is the number of consonants: SEAT has 2 (S, T) and CHARGE has 4 (C, H, R, G). ONLINE has 3 (N, L, N).

Q.14 · Answer (D) Kanan
Kamal is the shortest and Kishore the second shortest; Kushal is the tallest and Kishan the second tallest; Keshav, taller than only three, is fourth from the bottom. That leaves Kanan third shortest.

Q.16 · Answer (C) O1
Facing outwards, a man's left is the next seat anticlockwise. Counting clockwise from O4 to O5 and from O3 to O4 would put O5 on O3's immediate left, where O1 must sit, so the gaps run clockwise from O5 to O4 and from O4 to O3: clockwise, O5, O2, O4, O1, O3. Counting to the left of O2: O5, O3, then O1.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 1
'Intelligent' is common to the first two sentences and 5 to their codes; 'Nikhil' is common to the last two and 3 to theirs. So in '153', 'is' is 1.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Both conclusions I and II follow
No pineapple is a broccoli, but potatoes need not all be broccolis, so peas and pineapples may both be potatoes outside the broccolis: both possibilities hold.

Q.20 · Answer (C) YI
The first letters move 6 forward (G, M, S, Y, E) and the second letters 6 back (A, U, O, I, C): YI.

Q.21 · Answer (A) ab #
'Grey' is common to the first two sentences and '#' to their codes; 'of' is common to the first and third and 'ab' to theirs. So 'grey of' is written 'ab #'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Neither I nor II
After the interchange, I becomes $9 \times 2 - 72 \div 12 + 57 = 18 - 6 + 57 = 69$ and II becomes $169 \div 13 \times 9 + 3 - 12 = 117 + 3 - 12 = 108$. Both are correct, so neither is wrong.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Mehak
Facing north, left is west. Rakesh is on Ajay's immediate left, so Ajay is at the right end with Rakesh next to him and Priti at the left end. Saloni and Yogesh take the two middle seats, so Mehak sits second from the left, immediately right of Priti.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Plate
A car is a kind of vehicle and a pizza a kind of food; likewise a plate is a piece of crockery.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Lala Lajpat Rai
Lala Lajpat Rai, called 'Punjab Kesari' (the Lion of Punjab), died in Lahore on 17 November 1928, weeks after he was injured in a police lathi charge during a protest against the Simon Commission.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 10th
The Tenth Amendment Act, 1961 made Dadra and Nagar Haveli a Union Territory. The Twelfth (1962) did the same for Goa, Daman and Diu, and the Fourteenth (1962) for Puducherry.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Manipuri
Guru Bipin Singh (1918-2000) was a leading teacher, choreographer and scholar of Manipuri dance, who founded the Manipuri Nartanalaya in Kolkata.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
SAAR is a programme of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs and the National Institute of Urban Affairs in which 15 leading architecture and planning institutes document landmark projects of the Smart Cities Mission.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Nagaland
Moatsu is the festival of the Ao Nagas of Nagaland, held in the first week of May after the sowing season.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Only I
Mahapadma Nanda founded the Nanda dynasty, which ruled the Magadha empire. Ajatasattu (Ajatashatru) was a king of Magadha of the earlier Haryanka dynasty, long before the Mauryas, so only I is correct.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Two
Igneous rocks are of two types: intrusive (plutonic) rocks, which cool slowly from magma below the surface, such as granite, and extrusive (volcanic) rocks, which cool fast from lava on it, such as basalt.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Run out
A run out is a way of dismissing a batter in cricket. The scoop, the flick and the hit are strokes in hockey.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Karnataka
The fort stands at Gulbarga (now Kalaburagi) in northern Karnataka, the first capital of the Bahmani Sultanate, founded in 1347.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Gross Value Added = Gross Domestic Product + Subsidies – Taxes
GVA (at basic prices) is GDP (at market prices) less the taxes on products plus the subsidies on products.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Antacid
An antacid is a mild base that neutralises excess acid in the stomach, relieving indigestion and acidity. Analgesics relieve pain, antiseptics stop the growth of germs on living tissue, and antibiotics kill bacteria.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Bangladesh
World Bank figures for 2020 put Bangladesh at well over 1,000 people per square kilometre of land, more than twice India's (over 450). Sri Lanka (about 350), China (about 150) and Russia (under 10) were all less densely populated than India.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar
B R Ambedkar wrote 'Waiting for a Visa', a short, unfinished account of untouchability drawn mostly from his own experiences, in 1935-36.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Slumdog Millionaire
A R Rahman won two Grammy Awards in 2010 for 'Slumdog Millionaire': for its soundtrack album and for the song 'Jai Ho'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Kathak
Shovana Narayan is a Kathak dancer and teacher, honoured with the Padma Shri.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Forty-second Amendment Act
The Forty-second Amendment Act, 1976, on the recommendation of the Swaran Singh Committee, added the Fundamental Duties as Part IV-A (Article 51A).

Q.17 · Answer (B) Kakatiya
Rudramadevi was a ruler of the Kakatiya dynasty in the 13th century, governing from Warangal (Orugallu) in present-day Telangana.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Joule
Work is measured in joules: 1 joule is the work done when a force of 1 newton moves its point of application 1 metre. Pascal is the unit of pressure, hertz of frequency, and the decibel measures sound level.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Gram
Gram is a rabi crop, sown in winter and harvested in spring. Groundnut, maize and paddy are kharif crops, sown with the monsoon.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Damodar Mauzo
The Konkani writer Damodar Mauzo of Goa was named for the 57th Jnanpith Award in December 2021, along with the Assamese poet Nilmani Phookan for the 56th. Krishna Sobti, Kedarnath Singh and Amitav Ghosh received earlier Jnanpith Awards.

Q.21 · Answer (A) occupational structure
Occupational structure is how a population is divided among occupations, such as farming, manufacturing and services. Age composition is its division by age.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Deuteromycetes

Deuteromycetes are called the imperfect fungi because no sexual stage is known for them: they reproduce only by asexual spores (conidia). When a sexual stage is found, the fungus is moved to the Ascomycetes or Basidiomycetes.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Deccan plateau

SSC's key gives the Deccan Plateau: the Western Ghats and the Eastern Ghats mark its western and eastern edges, and of the options it is the only one the two Ghats belong to. (NCERT's Class 9 geography divides the Peninsular Plateau into the Central Highlands and the Deccan Plateau.)

Q.24 · Answer (B) Siraj-ud-daulah

Siraj-ud-daulah, Alivardi Khan's grandson, succeeded him as Nawab of Bengal in 1756; he lost the Battle of Plassey to the East India Company in 1757.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Aditi Ashok

Aditi Ashok is a golfer; she finished fourth in women's golf at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics. Abhinav Bindra is a shooter, Neeraj Chopra a javelin thrower and Ravi Kumar Dahiya a wrestler.

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